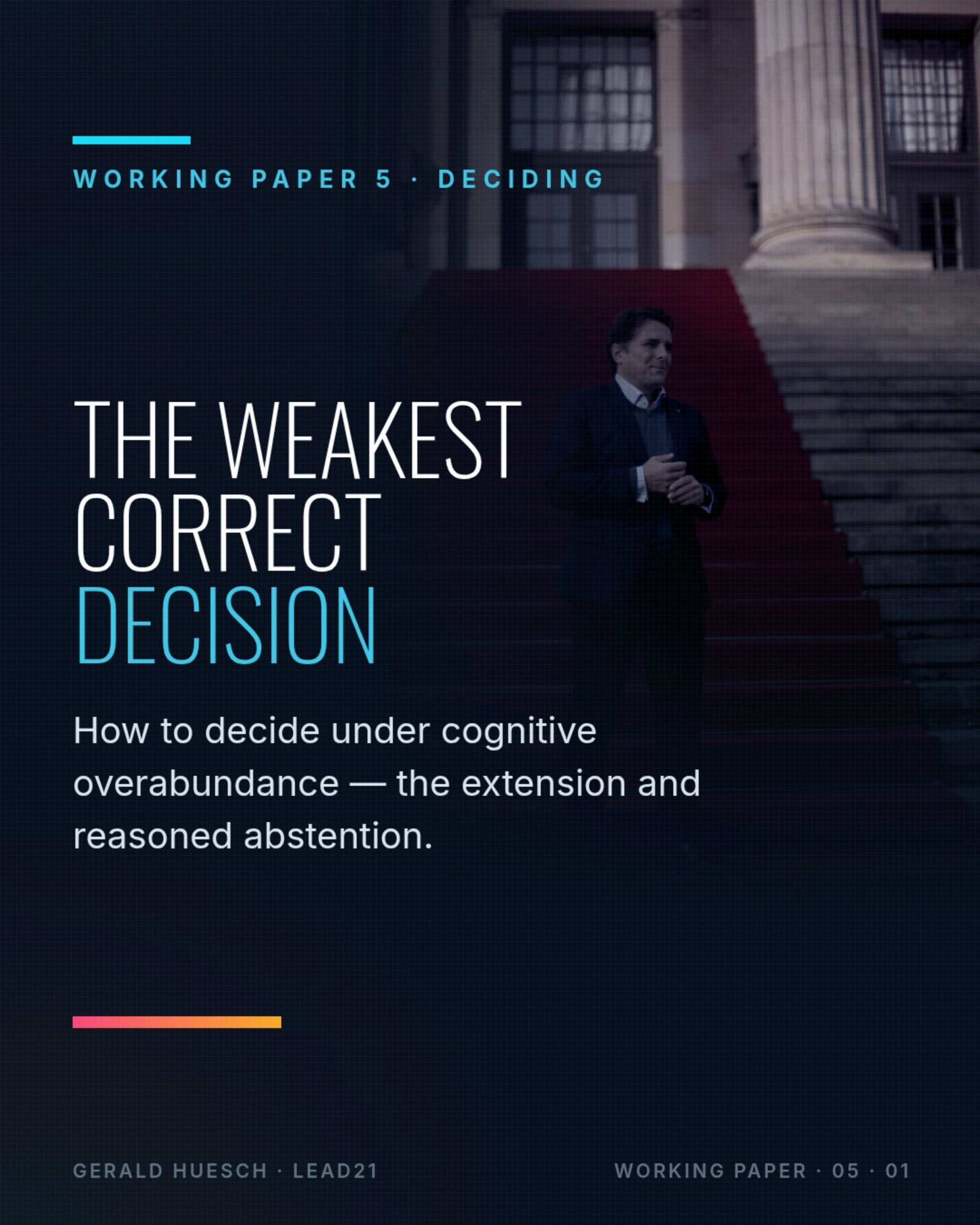




WORKING PAPER 5 · DECIDING

THE WEAKEST CORRECT DECISION

How to decide under cognitive
overabundance — the extension and
reasoned abstention.

THE WRONG RAZOR.



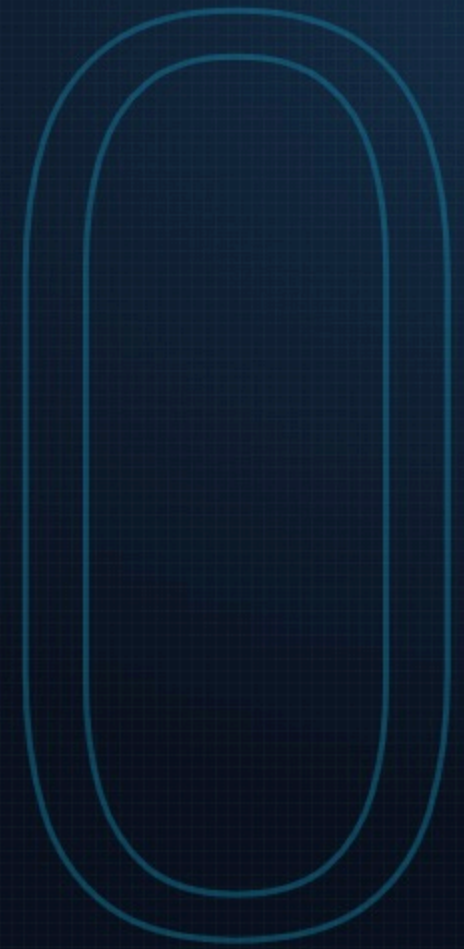
"Do not ask which correct policy is shortest. Ask which correct policy makes the fewest further commitments."

Bennett attacks Ockham at the root: the rule "take the shortest correct description" is not wrong, it is **empty** — on a finite class, any prior can be made Ockham-like by a suitable code. "What counts as short depends on the encoding."

His replacement is **weakness**: the number of commitments an option leaves open. Under exchangeable, as yet unknown requirements, the weakest correct policy is Bayes optimal.

Bennett, M. T. (2026): The wrong razor. AGI 2026, Part I, LNCS 16854, pp. 48–61. Springer.

THE FREEZE.



Orban models coordination as an engineering problem and names the state that arises when decision speed exceeds verification capacity: the **Freezing Equilibrium**.

When verifying a recommendation costs more than its expected benefit, both stop — the verifying and the acting. **Inaction becomes the rational choice.**

His model predicts sharp transitions between self-healing and self-destabilizing states. This is not a motivation problem. **It is a computation.**

Orban, D. (2026): Civilizational metamaterials — Engineering coordination under capability gradients and structural turbulence. AGI 2026, Part II, LNCS 16855, pp. 118–136. Springer.

WEAKNESS GAIN PER EFFORT.

Goertzel turns weakness into a priority signal: $\rho_s = \Delta w_s / \text{cost}(s)$ — how much openness a step gains, divided by the effort it costs.

"Not literally all you need — but a coordination principle."

For leadership groups this means: not ranking by urgency, but by the ratio of room gained to effort spent. Not as an exact figure — **as a shared question.**

Goertzel, B. (2026): Weakness is all you need — A generalized Occam bias for artificial general intelligence. Conference poster, 19th Conference on Artificial General Intelligence (AGI-26), San Francisco State University, 27–30 July 2026. Poster documented first-hand; proceedings entry pending.

TWENTY MINUTES LONGER.

The left path is shorter and leads safely to the intermediate camp. The right is twenty minutes longer and opens at the top onto a field from which **three further routes** remain available.

Both paths are correct. The experienced guide takes the right one — not because he is better informed, but because he knows that up there **he will not yet know what the weather is doing.**

THE CHEAPEST OPTION IS THE NARROWEST.

A is the cheapest and fits today's processes exactly. B costs twenty per cent more and leaves open two process variants nobody needs today. C is the most expensive and ties up eighteen months of implementation.

The usual evaluation picks A. **By weakness, B wins** — correct for today, and the most open without blocking the calendar.

Every additional commitment is a **purchase on credit**: it costs nothing today and everything on the day the situation turns.

"NOT TODAY."

01

What is missing? — which information exactly, not "more clarity"

02

When will it be available? — a date, not a condition

03

Who decides then, and **what holds until then?**

"We are not deciding this today" is a decision only if these three fields are filled. Without them, the postponement is not a resolution but a Freezing Equilibrium with better manners.

THE WEAKEST CORRECT DECISION.

Among all correct options, choose the one that **forces the fewest further commitments**. And every decision needs a level and a person — otherwise inaction becomes the rational choice.

The 5+1 Baskets of Decision-Making solve exactly what Orban describes formally: they ensure every decision has a level and a person. That blocks the most common route into the Freezing Equilibrium — **the contradiction that belongs to nobody**.

What is missing is the selection criterion itself: **the extension and reasoned abstention are open**.

NEXT

SEND ME "LEADERSHIP".

as a direct message — and I will send you the working paper as a PDF. Free, no newsletter.

Gerald Huesch — developer of LEAD21, the Leadership OS. Has trained over 30,000 leaders in 30+ countries, including NASA and Rolls-Royce.

All eight papers: gerald-huesch.com/press-en